

THE UFO PHENOMENON: OVERVIEW

Summary

For more than 40 years, people throughout the U.S. and many other countries have reported seeing unidentified flying objects. While most witnesses to UFOs are average persons, thousands are among the most highly skilled and experienced of observers: military personnel, pilots, policemen, and scientists.

* Documents released by U.S. military and intelligence agencies reveal that U.S. and foreign military personnel have reported close encounters with UFOs--in some cases, with radar confirmation--and high-ranking military officers have considered these reports seriously.

* The U.S.S.R. and several Western European countries have studied the UFO phenomenon in an official capacity. The U.S.S.R. National Academy of Sciences has recently launched a major investigation into the UFO phenomenon.

* Prominent government officials and scientists from the U.S. and around the world have indicated that the UFO phenomenon is serious and important. In the U.S., they range from Sen. Barry Goldwater and Admiral Roscoe Hillenkoetter (first CIA Director) to Dr. Margaret Mead (anthropologist) and Clyde Tombaugh (astronomer who discovered the planet Pluto).

* Photographs and motion pictures taken of UFOs have been closely analyzed by scientists and photography experts, and have been pronounced authentic.

* Nationwide Gallup polls consistently show that approximately 50% of the adult population consider UFOs to be real.

* U.S. military and intelligence agencies have a checkered history of investigating the UFO phenomenon. The Air Force began an intensive, and classified, investigation of UFO reports soon after World War II, and continued a public investigation of UFO reports until 1969. Since then, documents released under the Freedom of Information Act reveal that military and intelligence agencies continue to investigate UFO reports by military personnel.

Discussion

I. U.S. Military Documents

Over the last ten years, military and intelligence agencies have released some 7,000 pages of UFO-related documents, as a result of Freedom of Information Act requests by UFO researchers. These documents, many of which were formerly classified, reveal numerous UFO sightings by U.S. and foreign military pilots, guards, and other personnel. Some of these sightings occurred over U.S. military bases, and some were confirmed by radar. Many of these reports were circulated to high-ranking officers and policy-makers.

These U.S. government documents provide strong evidence that certain UFO reports merit scientific study because highly credible observers witness UFOs. In addition, these documents suggest that military and intelligence agencies investigate certain UFO reports.

Several U.S. military and intelligence agencies have acknowledged having additional UFO-related documents, but have declined to release them for national security reasons.

A. Lake Erie, Ohio--1988.

A Coast Guard document describes a sighting by Coast Guard personnel of a UFO that dispersed smaller UFOs, and then landed on an iced-over part of Lake Erie, east of Cleveland, on March 4, 1988:

SUBJ: Incident Report: Unidentified
Flying Objects....

1. Unidentifiable flying objects 1/4 mile
east of CEI Power Plant.

2. At 2035...this station rcvd a call
from [a private citizen]...rptng a large object
hovering over the lake.... The object had a
white light and was approx. 1/4 mile up....
This unit sent 2 crewmembers to investigate.

Before they arrived [on-site] we rcvd 2
more calls rptng that the object had apparently
dispersed 3-5 smaller flying objects that were
zipping around rather quickly. These objects
had...the ability to stop and hover in mid flight.

When Mobile 02 got [on-site], they rptd the
same activity. They watched the objects for
approx. 1 hour before rptng that the large
object was almost on the ice. They rptd that
the ice was cracking and moving abnormal amounts
as the object came closer to it. The ice was
rumbling and the object lit multi-color lights
at each end as it apparently landed....

This document is included in Attachment 1A.

B. Kirtland Air Force Base, N.M.--1980.

According to an Air Force document, on August 8, 1980, four security guards at Kirtland Air Force Base, New Mexico observed a UFO land and then take off. According to the document, just before midnight, three guards--

observed a very bright light in the sky.... The light traveled with great speed and stopped suddenly in the sky over Coyote Canyon.... [The guards] felt a helicopter couldn't have performed such skills. The light landed in the Coyote Canyon area....

One half hour later, a fourth security guard driving in the Coyote Canyon area--

observed a bright light near the ground behind [a secured installation].... [A]fter driving closer, he observed a round disk shaped object.... As he approached the object on foot armed with a shotgun, the object took off in a vertical direction at a high rate of speed. The guard was a former helicopter mechanic in the U.S. Army and stated the object he observed was not a helicopter.

This document is included in Attachment 1B.

Other U.S. military documents describing other UFO sightings by U.S. and foreign military personnel include:

- * Peru Air Force Base, La Joya, Peru--1980 (UFO sighted near Peruvian Air Force Base; jet fighters scrambled). See Attachment 1C.
- * Fort Ritchie, Maryland--1976 (several ground personnel observe a UFO in the vicinity of Fort Ritchie, MD). See Attachment 1D.
- * Malmstrom Air Force Base, Montana--1975 (numerous ground personnel observe UFOs during 3 consecutive nights; radar confirms UFO sightings; jet fighters scrambled). See Attachment 1E.

C. U.S. Military Documents Withheld Due to National Security

NORAD has identified 7,000 incidents of "air traffic declared unknown" over or near North America since 1971. Known as the NORAD Unknown Track Reporting System, this system is classified Secret. NORAD has declined to release information concerning the sightings on grounds of national security. See Attachment 1F.

The CIA has acknowledged having 57 UFO-related documents that it has refused to release, on grounds of national security.¹ The National Security Agency has acknowledged having 135 UFO-related documents that it has declined to release on grounds that release would jeopardize the NSA's intelligence gathering operations.²

II. Foreign Government Investigations of UFOs

Several foreign governments have studied the UFO phenomenon in an official capacity, including the U.S.S.R. and several Western European countries.

A. U.S.S.R.

1. Soviet Military Sighting of a UFO

An office within the U.S. Central Intelligence Agency, known as the Foreign Broadcast Information Service, recently published two reports on numerous articles concerning the UFO phenomenon that have appeared in leading Soviet newspapers from July, 1989 to April, 1990. (These reports are included as Attachments 2A and 2B.)

According to one of the CIA reports, Soviet military personnel reported a sensational UFO sighting near Moscow on March 21, 1990. Radar stations and aircraft assigned to the Soviet Air Defense Forces were placed on alert, and at least one fighter plane was scrambled to pursue the UFO. The pilot observed the object visually and detected it on radar. Ground personnel also observed the object visually and detected it on radar. All told, more than 100 visual observations were made of the UFO.

Col. General of Aviation, Igor Maltsev, Chief of the Main Staff of the Soviet Air Defense Forces, summarized the UFO sightings as follows:

"According to the evidence of these eyewitnesses, the UFO represented itself as a disk with a diameter of 100-200 meters.... [T]he object rotated around its axis and performed an 'S-turn' flight both in the horizontal and vertical planes.

Next, the UFO hovered above the ground and then flew at a speed that was 2-3 times that of modern jet fighters....

The objects flew at altitudes ranging from 1,000 to 7,000 meters. The movement of the UFO was not accompanied by sound of any kind and was distinguished by its startling maneuverability. It seemed that the UFO was completely devoid of inertia. In other words, they had somehow 'come to terms' with gravity.

At the present time, terrestrial machines could hardly have any such capabilities. The object was observed as a 'pip' from a radar target on the screens of aircraft radar sights and on the screens of electronic surveillance units...." (Paragraphing revised for clarity.)³

2. U.S.S.R. Scientific Studies of the UFO Phenomenon

The U.S.S.R. has recently established a scientific institute affiliated with the U.S.S.R. Academy of Sciences--the All-Union Interbranch Ufological Scientific-Coordination Center--to represent the U.S.S.R. as a whole in research on the UFO phenomenon.⁴

An article recently published in the Soviet Military Review, an official military publication, described the U.S.S.R. Academy of Sciences as concluding the following concerning UFOs:

"According to the U.S.S.R. Academy of Sciences, some 90-95% of UFO reports are a result of [terrestrial] causes.... But the remaining share constitutes tens of thousands of unexplained phenomena."⁵

In October, 1989, the Soviet Union opened an official center in Moscow to study UFOs, as part of the Palace of Culture and Power Engineers. Physicists, geologists, astronomers, and psychologists teach courses concerning the characteristics of UFOs that have been reported and the equipment necessary to investigate UFO sightings.⁶

Numerous nongovernmental scientific institutes also study the UFO phenomenon in the U.S.S.R. See pages 13-14 below.

B. Belgium

In June, 1990, the Belgium Air Force released a report, including radar photographs, of a 75-minute chase by two F-16 fighters of a UFO over Brussels on the night of March 30-31, 1990. During the chase, both planes detected the UFO on their radar; two ground radar installations also detected it; and numerous witnesses, including 20 national policemen, observed the UFO visually.

The Belgium Air Force stated:

"[On three occasions during the chase,] the pilots managed to get their radars locked on the object, with the immediate result that the object's behavior drastically changed. The object literally played hide and seek with the fighters. It dived toward the ground to evade the airborne and ground radars. Then it climbed back into radar range in a leisurely manner, thus initiating a new chase."

See Attachment 3 for a translation of a French magazine article, in Paris Match, describing the Belgium Air Force report and including the radar photographs.

From October, 1989 to July, 1990, Belgium experienced a wave of almost daily UFO sightings. Hundreds of national policemen, military and civilian pilots, air traffic controllers, and other competent observers reported UFOs. During part of this period, the Belgium Air Force kept military aircraft on standby, equipped with an infrared video camera, and the Air Force cooperated with civilian scientists in researching the UFO sightings.⁷

C. France

Beginning in 1977, an office within the French space agency issued a series of reports on the UFO phenomenon. For example, the office--known as the Groupe d'Etudes Phenomenes Aerospatiaux Non Identifies ("GEPAN")--stated:

- * From 1974-85, the French national police force received approximately 480 reports of UFO sightings that could not be explained in conventional terms.

- * GEPAN stated that "these unidentified phenomena still escape our comprehension and our scientific knowledge".⁸

GEPAN conducted an important investigation of a report by an eyewitness that on January 8, 1981, a small, circular UFO landed, then almost immediately took off again, near his home in Trans en Provence. GEPAN investigators found a circular marking on the ground at the landing site, and evidence that the ground had been subject to heat and pressure from an unknown source. Most importantly, GEPAN investigators found that the plants at the landing site had undergone inexplicable biochemical changes--in effect, premature aging--that, according to one French scientist, "does not resemble anything known to exist on our planet". The head of GEPAN concluded:

"We are in the presence of traces for which there is no satisfactory explanation and we can find no reason to suspect that the eyewitness is deliberately lying. For the first time we found a combination of factors which leads us to accept that something similar to what the eyewitness described actually did happen."

See Attachment 4A for a summary of the investigation results.

D. Portugal

On January 14, 1987, a spokesman for the Government of Portugal stated that with respect to UFOs:

"[T]he position of our Government is of cautious alert. Pilots of the Portuguese Air Force are instructed to register details of any non-identified objects which they might see while flying."

The Portuguese Government has made publicly available UFO sighting reports by Portuguese Air Force pilots.⁹ See Attachment 4B.

E. Italy

The Italian Air Force requires pilots to report UFO sightings on a specially prepared UFO sighting form. The Air Force has released a series of reports by military pilots and personnel concerning UFO sightings.¹⁰ See Attachment 4C.

III. U.S. and Foreign Government Officials

Highly placed government officials from the United States and around the world have declared that the UFO phenomenon is serious and important. They include, since World War II, military and intelligence officers of the highest rank, political leaders, and U.S. astronauts and Soviet cosmonauts.

A. United States

President Ronald Reagan. In the summer of 1974, while Governor of California, he observed a UFO while on a flight in his private plane, near Bakersfield, California. Mr. Reagan later told a reporter that as the pilot prepared to follow the UFO, "it went straight up" and disappeared. Following the incident, Mr. Reagan personally researched the UFO subject.¹¹

President Jimmy Carter. In October, 1969, while Governor of Georgia, he observed a UFO while standing outdoors waiting to give a speech before the local Lions Club in Leary, Georgia. He described the sighting in a UFO report form for a UFO research organization, which is included in Attachment 5A. After the sighting, he stated:

"I am convinced that UFOs exist because I have seen one."¹²

President Gerald R. Ford. In March, 1966, while House Minority Leader, he asked the House Armed Services Committee for hearings on the subject of UFOs, as a result of numerous UFO sightings in his district that the Air Force investigated and attempted to explain as misinterpretations of natural causes. He stated:

"Because I think there may be substance in some of these reports and because I believe the American people are entitled to a more thorough explanation than has been given them by the Air Force to date, I am proposing [that hearings be held].... I think we owe it to the people to establish credibility regarding UFOs and to produce the greatest possible enlightenment on this subject."

Mr. Ford's request resulted in hearings by the House Armed Services Committee (described below).¹³

President Lyndon B. Johnson. In July 1960, while Senate Majority Leader, he ordered the staff of the Senate Preparedness Investigations Subcommittee to report on significant UFO sightings and on the Air Force's investigation of such sightings.¹⁴

Sen. Barry M. Goldwater, Sr. Former U.S. Senator and Republican presidential candidate. In an April, 1988 interview, Sen. Goldwater stated:

"I used to receive a hundred calls a year from people who wanted me to get into the Green Room at Wright-Patterson Air Force Base, because

that's where the Air Force stored all the material gathered on UFOs. I once asked General Curtis LeMay if I could get into that room, and he just gave me holy hell. He said, 'Not only can't you get into it but don't you ever mention it to me again.'"

In a 1975 letter, Sen. Goldwater stated:

"About ten or twelve years ago I made an effort to find out what was in the building at Wright Patterson Air Force Base where the [UFO] information is stored that has been collected by the Air Force, and I was understandably denied this request. It is still classified above Top Secret."

This letter and the interview are reprinted in Attachment 5B.

Air Force Chief of Staff General Curtis LeMay. In his autobiography, Mission With LeMay (1985), he stated that although the bulk of UFO reports could be explained as conventional or natural phenomena, some could not: "There were some cases we could not explain. Never could."

Admiral Roscoe Hillenkoetter. First director of the CIA (1947-1950). In 1960 he stated:

"Unknown objects are operating under intelligent control....It is imperative that we learn where UFOs come from and what their purpose is...."¹⁵

In August, 1960, Admiral Hillenkoetter called for congressional hearings. Numerous military officers endorsed his request, including Rear Admiral H. B. Knowles, and Rear Admiral D. S. Fahrney (former chief of the Navy missile program).¹⁶

Chairman of the Joint Chiefs of Staff General Nathan Twining. In 1947, while holding the rank of Lieutenant General, commanding the Air Materiel Command, he was given the responsibility for investigating UFO sightings. He concluded:

"The [UFO] phenomenon is something real and not visionary or fictitious....

The reported operating characteristics... and action which must be considered evasive when sighted or contacted by friendly aircraft and radar, lend belief to the possibility that some of the objects are controlled either manually, automatically, or remotely."

House Committee on Science, Space, and Technology. On July 29, 1968, the Committee, then-named the House Committee on Science and Astronautics, held a hearing concerning UFOs. The Committee

received testimony from 12 prominent scientists, ten of whom supported scientific study of UFOs.¹⁷ See Attachment 5C.

House Committee on Armed Services. On April 5, 1966, the Committee held open hearings on UFOs. Secretary of the Air Force Harold D. Brown, the Chief of the Air Force project to investigate UFO reports--Project Blue Book--and the scientific advisor of Project Blue Book testified. See Attachment 5D.

Eugene Cernan. Astronaut, Commander of Apollo 17:

"I'm one of those guys who has never seen a UFO. But I've been asked, and I've said publicly I thought they were somebody else, some other civilization."¹⁸

L. Gordon Cooper. Astronaut, Mercury 9. In 1978, he gave a statement before a United Nations committee discussing UFOs:

"I believe that these extra-terrestrial vehicles and their crews are visiting this planet from other planets...."¹⁹

B. Great Britain.

Lord Hill-Norton (GCB). Chief of Defence Staff, Ministry of Defense (1971-73); Member of House of Lords. In 1987, he stated:

"The evidence that there are objects which have been seen in our atmosphere, and even on terra firma, that cannot be accounted for either as man-made objects or as any physical force or effect known to our scientists seems to me to be overwhelming.... [A] very large number of sightings have been vouched for by persons whose credentials seem to me unimpeachable. It is striking that so many have been trained observers, such as police officers and airline or military pilots. Their observations have in many instances...been supported either by technical means such as radar or, even more convincingly, by...interference with electrical apparatus of one sort or another...."²⁰

Lord Hill-Norton's Forward is included as Attachment 5E.

House of Lords. On January 18, 1979, a debate on UFOs took place in the House of Lords when Lord Clancarty moved to establish a government study of the UFO phenomenon. Due to the Government's opposition, Lord Clancarty withdrew the motion without a formal vote.

However, ten members of the House of Lords--the majority of those who spoke on the issue--supported a government study, or otherwise indicated that the UFO phenomenon was important.²¹

In June 1979, Lord Clancarty formed the House of Lords All-Party UFO Study Group, and some 30 Lords participated. The UFO Study Group had monthly meetings, and invited as guest speakers prominent UFO researchers from around the world. (The group stopped meeting when Lord Clancarty fell ill.)²²

Air Chief Marshal Lord Dowding. British Commander-in-Chief of the Royal Air Force Fighter Command during the Battle of Britain in 1940. He stated in 1954:

"More than 10,000 sightings have been reported, the majority of which cannot be accounted for by any "scientific" explanation....They have been tracked on radar screens...and the observed speeds have been as great as 9,000 miles an hour....I am convinced that these objects do exist and that they are not manufactured by any nation on earth. I can therefore see no alternative to accepting the theory that they come from some extraterrestrial source...."²³

C. France.

Defense Minister M. Robert Galley. Minister of Defense M. Robert Galley, in an interview on February 21, 1974, stated, concerning the 1973-74 wave of UFO sightings:

"[I]f your listeners could see for themselves the mass of [UFO] reports coming in from the [Gendarmerie--the French police force that is under the Armed Forces]..., then they would see that it is all pretty disturbing."²⁴

General Lionel M. Chassin. Commanding General of the French Air Forces; and General Air Defense Coordinator, Allied Air Forces, Central Europe (NATO). From 1964 until his death in 1970, he was president of a French UFO research group:²⁵

"The number of thoughtful, intelligent, educated people in full possession of their faculties who have 'seen something' and described it grows every day.... [M]ysterious objects have indeed appeared and continue to appear in the sky that surrounds us."²⁶

D. U.S.S.R.

Col. General of Aviation Igor Maltsez. Chief of the Main Staff of the Soviet Air Defense Forces. In March, 1990, he issued a statement to the Soviet press describing a UFO sighting near Moscow, on March 21, 1990, witnessed by numerous Soviet military personnel and detected on radar. See page 4, above.

Former Cosmonaut Pavel Papovitch. He is the chairman of the Commission for the Investigation of Anomalous Atmospheric Phenomenon, a UFO research organization founded in 1985.²⁷

Cosmonaut E. V. Khrunov. In 1979 he stated:

The UFO problem exists, and it is extremely serious. Thousands of people have seen UFOs.... We are going to have to make a thorough investigation.... It is entirely possible that, concealed behind this question, there lies the problem of communication with extraterrestrial civilizations.²⁸

Air Force Major-General Porfiri Stolyarov. He was chairman of the UFO Section of the All-Union Committee on Cosmonautics of the DOSAAF (the Soviet equivalent of the U.S. Department of Defense), which existed in 1968.²⁹

E. Japan.

Lieutenant-General Akira Hirano. Chief of Staff of the Japan Air Self-Defense Force. In September, 1977, he stated: "We frequently see unidentified objects in the skies."³⁰

General Kanshi Ishikawa. Chief of Staff of Japan's Air Self-Defense Force. In 1967, he stated:

"Much evidence tells us [UFOs] have been tracked by radar; so, UFOs are real and they may come from outer space.... UFO photographs and various materials show scientifically that there are more advanced people piloting the saucers and motherships."³¹

F. Brazil.

Aeronautical Minister Moreira Lima. On May 21, 1988, Brazil's Aeronautical Minister, Brigadier General Octavio Moreira Lima, announced a sensational UFO encounter: On May 19, 1986, Brazil's radar defense system detected 20 UFOs that overflowed Sao Paulo and Rio de Janeiro. Four Air Force fighter planes were scrambled, and the pilots made visual and radar contact. According to the Aeronautical Minister, "for several minutes... the [Air Force] fighters became pursued by the unidentified flying objects", and one fighter became surrounded by 13 UFOs. The UFOs then disappeared. Acknowledging that "[t]echnically, there is no explanation" for the events, the Minister added, "The appearance of unidentified flying objects already occurred before in Brazil, but never with this intensity."³²

G. Spain.

General Carlos Castro Cervero. Spanish Air Force General. He stated in a 1976 interview that at high levels within the Spanish Government, UFOs were taken quite seriously. He added:

[I]n my own personal capacity, [not as a General], I have for some time held the view that UFOs are extraterrestrial craft."³³

IV. U.S. and Foreign Scientists

Many prominent scientists around the world have declared, since World War II, that the UFO phenomenon is important and merits scientific study. Many scientists have themselves sighted UFOs.

For example, the following astronomers, among others, have sighted UFOs:

Dr. Seymour L. Hess, Lowell Observatory, Arizona³⁴
Dr. Lincoln La Paz, University of New Mexico³⁵
Clyde W. Tombaugh, discoverer of planet Pluto (see below)³⁶
Walter N. Webb, Boston Museum of Science³⁷
Sir H. Percy Wilkins, director of the British Astronomical Association, Lunar Section³⁸

A. United States

Clyde W. Tombaugh. American astronomer who discovered the planet Pluto. After observing a UFO in 1949, he stated: "I was so unprepared for such a strange sight that I was really petrified with astonishment." See Attachment 6A for a letter by Dr. Tombaugh describing his sighting.³⁹

Dr. Margaret Mead. World-renowned anthropologist. She stated:

"There are unidentified flying objects. That is, there are a hard core of cases -- perhaps 20 to 30 percent in different studies -- for which there is no explanation....

[W]e can only imagine what purpose lies behind the activities of these quiet, harmlessly cruising objects that time and again approach the earth. The most likely explanation, it seems to me, is that they are simply watching what we are up to...." (Emphasis in original.)⁴⁰

House Science Committee Symposium on UFOs: See page 8 above for a discussion of the 1968 hearing by the House Committee on Science, Space and Technology concerning UFOs.

Dr. Peter A. Sturrock. Professor of Space Science and Astrophysics and Deputy Director of the Center for Space Sciences and Astrophysics at Stanford University; director of the Skylab Workshop on Solar Flares (1977). He has stated:

"The definitive resolution of the UFO enigma will not come about unless and until the problem is subjected to open and extensive scientific study by the normal procedures of established science."⁴¹

Dr. Robert M. L. Baker, Jr. President of West Coast University; author of two astrodynamics textbooks; head of Lockheed's Astrodynamics Research Center (1961-64); developer of orbit methods; faculty of Astronomy and Engineering at UCLA (1959-71).

He has studied motion pictures of UFOs and anomalistic radar returns. He has concluded that two UFO motion pictures, taken in the 1950s, involved genuine UFOs. In addition, in 1968, he testified before the House Committee on Science, Space, and Technology that a partially classified U.S. military radar system, for which he had a security clearance, had detected "a number of" UFOs.⁴²

American Astronomical Society Survey. In a 1977 survey of 1,356 members of the American Astronomical Society, 53 percent of the respondents stated that UFOs "certainly" or "probably" should be studied further.⁴³

American Institute of Aeronautics and Astronautics UFO Subcommittee. The American Institute of Aeronautics and Astronautics ("AIAA") established a subcommittee in 1967 to look into the UFO question. The UFO Subcommittee issued several reports and statements, including in-depth studies of two UFO sightings. The Subcommittee stated:

[F]rom a scientific and engineering standpoint, it is unacceptable to simply ignore substantial numbers of unexplained observations....[T]he only promising approach is a continuing moderate-level effort with emphasis on improved data collection by objective means....

The Subcommittee stated that its "most important conclusion" was that government agencies consider funding UFO research.⁴⁴ See Attachment 6B for a statement by the UFO Subcommittee, which was published in Astronautics & Aeronautics, the AIAA journal.

B. The Soviet Union

The U.S.S.R. conducts the most extensive scientific investigation of the UFO phenomenon in the world. Some of the major scientific activities include:

U.S.S.R. Academy of Sciences. See page 5, above, for a discussion of the activities of the U.S.S.R. Academy of Sciences, and other Soviet scientific activities.

In 1979, the Institute of Space Research of the U.S.S.R. Academy of Sciences published a 74-page statistical analysis of over 250 UFO cases reported in the Soviet Union. After stating that hallucinations, errors, and conventional explanations (aircraft, satellites, etc.) could not account for many of the reports, the study called for further detailed investigation of UFO sightings. The study concluded, "[T]he question of the nature of the anomalous phenomena still should be considered open."⁴⁵

The Commission on Paranormal Events. Established in 1984, the Commission is a non-governmental organization under the Council of Scientific and Engineering Societies, and is headed by V.S. Troitsky, a Corresponding Member of the U.S.S.R. Academy of Sciences.

The U.S.S.R. Commission has collected thousands of UFO reports. It has concluded:

"[E]ven when the reports carry enough details, around 10% of the events cannot be identified. It is these events, stubbornly defying attempts to find what they actually are, that interest UFO-[Paranormal Event] investigators most of all."

A copy of a Soviet magazine article describing the work of the Commission on Paranormal Events, is included as Attachment 6C.

Other Soviet Scientific Institutes

Other U.S.S.R. scientific institutes that investigate aspects of the UFO phenomenon include:

- * The Union of Scientific and Engineering Societies includes a newly established All-Union Commission for the Study of Unidentified Flying Objects, chaired by physical scientist Vladimir Azhazha.⁴⁶
- * The All-Union Astronomical and Geodesic Society includes a section assigned to the study of anomalous phenomena, chaired by Dr. Anatoliy Listratov, a physical scientist.⁴⁷
- * The Arctic and Antarctic Scientific Research Institute, in Leningrad.⁴⁸
- * The Institute of Applied Geophysics, in Obninsk.⁴⁹
- * The Far East Division of the U.S.S.R. Academy of Sciences.⁵⁰

Some Soviet scientists take a skeptical view of the UFO phenomenon, including Vladimir Vasilyevich Migulin, director of the Terrestrial Magnetism, Ionosphere, and Radio Wave Propagation Institute in Troitsk, which has a section for the investigation of anomalous phenomena in the atmosphere.⁵¹

C. France

French Space Agency. See page 6 above for a discussion of the work of GEPAN, an office within the French Space Agency that has investigated UFO sightings.

D. Peoples Republic of China

China Society of UFO Research. The China Society of UFO Research includes some 40,000 members, including 5,000 professionals. As of 1985, this group had two publications: "Exploration of UFO" and "Space Exploration".

Chairman of the Chinese Society, Professor Liang Renglin of Guangzhou Jinan University, has reported that over 600 UFO reports were made during 1980-1985, including well-documented sightings by military pilots.⁵²

E. Other World Famous Scientists

Dr. Carl Gustav Jung. World-renowned Swiss psychologist. He was a consultant to a U.S. UFO research group. He stated:

"A purely psychological explanation is ruled out by the fact that a large number of observations indicate a natural one, even a physical one.... [T]he 'discs'...do not behave in accordance with physical laws but as though without weight, and they show signs of intelligent guidance, by quasi-human pilots." (Emphasis in original.)⁵³

Dr. Hermann Oberth. German rocket expert. In 1955, Dr. Wernher von Braun invited him to the U.S. where he worked on rockets with the Army Ballistic Missile Agency and later NASA. He was Honorable Chairman of a German UFO research group. He described his view of UFO propulsion as follows:

"They produce high-tension electric charges in order to push the air out of their path...and strong magnetic fields to influence the ionised air at higher altitudes.... This would explain their luminosity...[, noiseless] flight... [, and] the strong electrical and magnetic effects sometimes, but not always, observed in the vicinity of UFOs."⁵⁴

Dr. Paul Santorini. Greek physicist and engineer who developed fuses for atomic weapons and a guidance system for the NIKE missile. He has stated: "The UFOs are certainly a reality. Many of the observations are certainly conclusive."

In 1947, he investigated a series of UFO reports over Greece that were initially thought to be Soviet missiles. He stated:

"We soon established that they were not missiles. But, before we could do any more, the Army, after conferring with foreign officials, ordered the investigation stopped. Foreign scientists flew to Greece for secret talks with me."

He added that a "world blanket of secrecy" surrounded the UFO issue because the authorities were unwilling to admit the existence of a force against which there is "no possibility of defense".⁵⁵

F. Skeptical Scientists: Condon Report. See Attachment 10 for a summary of the 1968 project under the auspices of the University of Colorado to study the UFO phenomenon, in which Dr. Edward U. Condon, a prominent physicist, concluded that the UFO phenomenon did not merit further scientific study.